

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J T 8

♥ K T 8

♦ T 7 5

♣ Q T 5

♠ 7 6 4 2

♥ 7 6 3

♦ 8 6 4

♣ J 9 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 9

♥ Q 9 5

♦ A 9 3 2

♣ A 6 3

♠ 5 3

♥ A J 4 2

♦ K Q J

♣ K 7 4 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♣

1♠

Dbl

All Pass

2♣ by North

SOUTH has 14 points, a doubleton in the opponent's ♠ suit and at least three cards in each of the other suits. This is a normal Takeout Double.

NORTH has a really awful hand. He has just one point and his only 4-card suit is the one the opponents have already bid. He wants nothing more than to pass.

But he cannot pass. Partner's Double said "Bid your best suit.", so he bids 2♣.

Mercifully SOUTH also passes.

Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 8 5
♥ K Q T 5
♦ A K 3
♣ 4 2

♠ K 2

♥ A 8 4 2

♦ T 7 4

♣ J 9 7 5



♠ A J T 7
♥ J 7
♦ Q J 9 5
♣ A 8 3

♠ 6 4 3

♥ 9 6 3

♦ 8 6 2

♣ K Q T 6

With 14 points, ♣ shortage, and support for the other suits WEST makes a Takeout Double.

EAST has 13 points so she bids 2♣. This is an artificial bid, apprising WEST of EAST's opening hand strength, and forcing the partnership to reach the game level.

WEST suggests ♥s as trumps. EAST doesn't like ♥s so she suggests ♠s. WEST agrees with ♠s and bids game, 4♠.

West	North	East	South
			1♣
Dbl	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♥	Pass	2♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			
4♠ by East			

Board 3

West Deals

None Vul

♠ T 6
 ♥ K Q 4 3
 ♦ T 7 6
 ♣ K T 9 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ 9 6 5 2

♦ Q 5

♣ A 8 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 5 2

♥ A J T 8

♦ 9 8 4 2

♣ Q J 4

♠ A K J 9 8 3

♥ 7

♦ A K J 3

♣ 7 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	Pass	Pass	Dbl
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

WEST's 1 ♥ opening is passed around to SOUTH. He is tempted to overcall 1 ♠, but with 18 points is a little strong for a mere overcall. Instead, he doubles.

With 8 points NORTH is not strong enough to jump. She bids 2 ♣.

SOUTH now bids 2 ♠. By doubling first, then bidding his own suit, he shows a good suit and 17+ points.

NORTH raises to 4 ♠.

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 9
 ♥ K Q 8
 ♦ Q 7 4
 ♣ A Q 8 5

♠ K Q 4 2

♥ 5 3 2

♦ J 8 3

♣ J 7 4



♠ 8 7

♥ A 9 7 6

♦ A 6 2

♣ K 9 6 3

♠ T 6 5 3

♥ J T 4

♦ K T 9 5

♣ T 2

WEST has 18 points, a balanced hand, and a good stopper in their suit. He should overcall 1NT. For 1NT overcalls, the range is increased to 15-18 points.

EAST bids 2♣ (Stayman), just as she would with a 1NT opening. When WEST denies holding a 4-card Major EAST has enough points to bid 3NT. She doesn't worry about a ♠ stopper since WEST promised he had the suit controlled.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
1NT	Pass	2 ♣	Pass
2 ♦	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West			